

Lenovo Smart

With a view to promote smartbooks, Qualcomm's new Lenovo gadget will help users combine key features from smartphones and laptops



Triple assault

Nokia added three handsets, the Nokia 1506, 6316, 3806 to expand its CDMA portfolio. Of these 6316 seems to be the top of line with web browsing, music, imaging and GPS

Mobile watch

adopted with Android. Being an OS for the portability space, Google wants users to be able to log on to the web as much and as quickly as pos-

login screen in seven seconds. Google said it will take only another three seconds to be on the Web and browsing. Quite cool, that...



To watch Chrome OS videos, go to <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/chrome/>



sible and so in turn use the host of Google's services.

In a demonstration of the new Chrome OS at the Google headquarters at Mountain View, California, Pichai mentioned a few things that are worth noting. First, that the operating system is, as expected, a glorified version of the Chrome browser itself. The look and feel are pretty much the same, with just more eye-candy and features in the Chrome OS.

Also, the Chrome OS will work only on SSDs said Matthew Papakipos, Engineering Director for Google Chrome OS. That's right, no hard disks with moving parts will be supported. So if you planned on running this on your computer with a dual-boot system, think again! More importantly, Pichai said that the amount of hardware supported will be selective and Google will support only 'referenced hardware'. The company will be tying up with hardware manufacturers to offer the new Chrome OS on selected devices - netbooks, tablets, laptops or anything else. An open-source operating system on a closed line-up of devices? Irony, thy name is Google!

One extremely impressive factor of the demonstration was the boot-up time. From a cold boot on what looked like an Asus EEE netbook PC, Chrome OS was at the

Pichai stressed that the goals of Chrome OS are the same as that of the browser - speed, simplicity and security. The speed is obviously the reason that they are using only SSDs and not HDDs. To make simplicity a strong factor, the Chrome OS will be reliant completely on the cloud with almost no support whatsoever for offline usage. There will be no desktop applications available - none whatsoever! It's all in the cloud



A hacked iPhone

with this one, and aimed primarily at portability with devices like netbooks

Hacked iPhone - Pay me or else

Apple's products, including the iPhone have always had this unhackable virus proof appeal. Yet a teenager (PureIn-

finit92) managed to do exactly that - hack tons of iPhones. Many users got this message on their phones "your iPhone has been hacked because it's really insecure! Please visit so and so website/iHacked and secure your iPhone right now". The teenager was however only able to only hack jailbroken iPhones and asked for \$4.95 for instructions on getting rid of the message. Jailbreaking an iPhone is the technique used to be able to install third party applications on to iPhones. While this greatly broadens your reach to applications, this teaches iPhone users of the risks of Jailbreaking. It may seem like a cheap stunt or a mean trick but this goes a long way to educate users about using Jailbroken iPhones.

The phones affected were mainly in the Dutch IP range. To be fair to the hacker this is what the hacker had to say in his original post - If you don't pay, it's fine by me. But remember, the way I got access to your iPhone can be used by thousands of others. And they can send text messages from your number (like I did..), use it to call (or record your calls), and actually whatever they want, even use it for their hacking activities! I can assure you, I have no intention of harming you or whatever, but, some hackers do! It's just my advise to secure your phone (: Have a nice day!)"

On screen keyboard?

With the iPhone, came the first somewhat usable on screen keyboard that didn't necessitate using a painful stylus. Till then most people were

happy with the full QWERTY keyboards offered by phones such as Blackberry. QWERTY keyboards offer greater control and accuracy, while the argument for full touch on screen keyboards is that they help keep the form factor small and retain the design philosophy of the phone. Now there are two distinct factions within Smartphone user's market. One totally despises the other's philosophy and are mostly at war. There's even a small group that likes the traditional 12 button keypads. However we came across a research abstract that could spell a truce between the warring clans in the near future.

Strategy Analytics a research firm has found that consumers in both the US and Western Europe want a touchscreen keyboard on their next device, be it stand alone, or in combination with another physical keyboard. Respondents for the Strategy Analytics survey in the US favour a touchscreen combined with a QWERTY keyboard while those in Western Europe are most interested in a touchscreen only. Also despite strong interest in touchscreens and hybrid devices, a traditional 12-key keypad is still appealing to the Mass Market segment. No wonder the Omnia HD which we had with us recently, featured an on screen QWERTY as well as a 12 button keypad. "With interest in various keyboard combinations differing by segment, it is important for both device manufacturers and operators to offer a variety of keyboard options within their device portfolios." says the report.